

Chapter 177-16

Xu Qingzhu's due date was in August, right in the hot season.

The two little ones showed no signs of movement even ten days past the due date. Zhu Mingqi was extremely anxious, constantly asking Liang Shi if they should do another checkup.

Finally, in a quiet late night, Xu Qingzhu pressed the emergency bell by the bed.

Xu Qingzhu was sent to the operating room, and Liang Shi followed her in.

Giving birth was a long process—from two in the morning until seven in the morning. This was already considered relatively smooth.

The preparatory work in the early stages had been thorough, and they didn't encounter any special situations.

But it had already caused Xu Qingzhu tremendous pain. Her tears were almost cried dry.

Liang Shi held her hand, constantly soothing her by her ear: "Baby, hang in there a little longer."

"Darling, it'll be over soon."

"Wife, be good."

"Baby, don't fall asleep."

"..."

Liang Shi was so heartbroken she wanted to cry too. Her mind kept circling around—why have children? Why have children?

But thankfully, mother and daughters were safe.

She gave birth to twin daughters.

Liang Shi had already chosen names for them early on.

She and Xu Qingzhu had been using their surnames for so many years; she was too lazy to change them.

After all, names were just labels.

But the two girls' names still used their original surnames.

One had the surname Sheng, one had the surname Shen.

The older sister was called Sheng Yan, the younger sister was called Shen Xuan¹.

To avoid overlapping with Shen Siyan's name, they had put considerable thought into it.

The two children's nicknames were given by Xu Qingzhu.

Zhaohzao and Mumu².

"If love between two hearts is long, why must they be together morning and night?"³

But being together morning and night is what makes the heart flutter.

The day Liang Shi proposed to Xu Qingzhu was a sunny, pleasant day.

That year, Zhaohzao and Mumu were four years old, already at the age for kindergarten.

Of course, they could also be flower girls.

While Xu Qingzhu was washing up, Liang Shi walked into the bathroom and hugged her from behind. The water was still running, and Xu Qingzhu had just squeezed hand soap onto her hands when Liang Shi reached over, saying sweetly: "Wife, let me help you wash."

So Xu Qingzhu stopped moving, enjoying Liang Shi's service.

But when her hands were full of foam, her finger suddenly felt something cold being slipped onto it. Only after the water rinsed away the bubbles did Xu Qingzhu see the ring on her hand.

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi took half a step back, knelt on one knee, and looked up at her devoutly: "Xu Qingzhu, will you be with me for the rest of our lives? I will love you well."

Xu Qingzhu's eyes darted around. Although she was moved, she said stubbornly: "Where are my flowers? What kind of proposal doesn't have flowers?"

Liang Shi immediately clapped her hands.

Zhaozao and Mumu appeared wearing pink princess dresses, each holding a bouquet of flowers—passionate roses.

For a proposal, roses were needed to show sincerity.

Liang Shi smiled at Xu Qingzhu: "So, Xu Qingzhu, marry me."

Not "marry me" as in becoming hers, but "marry me" as in getting married together.

Together, they would spend the rest of their lives.

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment.

During the few seconds she was thinking, Liang Shi's heart was pounding like a drum, unable to stop.

Liang Shi said aggrievedly: "How much longer do you need to think?"

As she spoke, she even shook Xu Qingzhu's hand, meaning for her to look at the ring.

"You're already wearing the ring." Liang Shi said. "I've already claimed you in my embrace."

Xu Qingzhu cleared her throat lightly and said with great bravado: "Fine then. Since you're being so sincere, I'll reluctantly agree."

Liang Shi immediately broke into a smile.

After the proposal, Liang Shi began preparing for the wedding.

Her explanation to everyone was that because the previous wedding had been too simple, and neither set of parents had participated, they were having a proper one this time.

And also to let Zhaozao and Mumu participate.

This high-sounding excuse almost had Liang Shi herself convinced.

The truth was that she herself hadn't participated before either.

Liang Shi still decided to hold the wedding by the sea.

To let the ocean carry their longing and the celebration to those far away.

The wedding preparations went smoothly with the help of Zhao Xuning and Gu Yixue.

Zhao Xuning was in charge of setting up the venue, while Gu Yixue was in charge of filming on the wedding day.

Everyone was somewhat surprised when they learned Gu Yixue was responsible for this.

An internationally renowned director was actually filming something like this?

Gu Yixue shook her head helplessly: "Can't help it. Who told her she's the group's darling?"

"Great-Aunt." Zhaozao ran over after hearing this and asked: "Who's the group's darling? Me or Mumu?"

Gu Yixue: "...Both you and Mumu are."

Zhaozao stuck her tongue out at her: "Master of keeping balance?"⁴

Gu Yixue: "..."

Hearing this, Liang Shi laughed: "Major overturning scene."

"It's because your daughter is so clever and mischievous—she can't be fooled even at such a young age." Gu Yixue scoffed. "But Mumu is very well-behaved. She only likes to eat."

Liang Shi: "..."

Mumu, who was sneaking food at the wedding venue, immediately swallowed the cookie in her mouth. "Great-Aunt, I wasn't sneaking food."

Gu Yixue glanced at her and reached out to brush away the cookie crumbs from the corner of her mouth. "Little darling, remember to destroy the evidence, okay?"

Looking at her two daughters running around at the wedding venue, Liang Shi felt happiness overflowing.

Footnotes:

¹ The names Sheng Yan (盛妍) and Shen Xuan (沈暄) use the characters from the name Zhu Mingqi originally wanted to give Liang Shi—Shen Xuanyan (沈暄妍). "Xuan" (暄) means warm/bright like sunshine, and "Yan" (妍) means beautiful/elegant. By splitting the name between the twins, each child carries part of the name meant for their mother.

² Zhaozao (朝朝) and Mumu (暮暮) - These nicknames literally mean "morning morning" and "evening evening." Together they form the phrase "朝朝暮暮" (zhāo zhāo mù mù), meaning "every morning and every evening" or "day and night."

³ This is a famous line from the Song Dynasty poem "Immortal at the Magpie Bridge" (鵲橋仙) by Qin Guan. The full couplet is: "If love between two hearts is long, why must they be together morning and night?" (兩情若是久長時，又豈在朝朝暮暮). It's traditionally about long-distance love enduring through separation. However, the author flips the sentiment—while the poem suggests true love doesn't need constant togetherness, the response argues that being together every day is what makes love truly wonderful.

⁴ "Master of keeping balance" (端水大師) - Internet slang referring to someone who tries to treat multiple parties equally/fairly without showing favoritism, like carefully carrying a bowl of water without spilling (端水). Zhaozao is cheekily calling out Gu Yixue for giving a diplomatic answer that doesn't pick a favorite.